SWIM

Week 08 Swim

Week 8 of 52 | Mon 23 Nov 2026 to Sun 29 Nov 2026 | Month 2: Consolidate

The idea this month: short fast lengths with full rest, stroke count as the honesty check, fins as a teaching tool. Endurance volume comes back once the fast stroke is the default. 25 m pool. Every swim is 700-1,100 m and 22-35 minutes.

Monday, 23 Nov Swim 1 - Fast 50s, no fins (35 min)

Focus: The biggest fast set of the block, all bare-foot. This is the week you find out if the fins taught you anything.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Catch-up / 25 FS) r20
Main	8 x 50 fast r40, no fins. Note the time of each 50 off the watch and the stroke count. Aim: every 50 faster than 1:40 per 100 pace at 12-13 strokes per 25.
Easy	4 x 50 FS r20
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 1100 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no.

Thursday, 26 Nov Swim 2 - Twelve fast 25s (32 min)

Focus: Volume of fast lengths up, fins down.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Zipper / 25 FS) r20
Main	12 x 25 fast r30. Fins on 1-4, then 8 without. Same count, same feel, no fins.
Easy	4 x 50 FS r20
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 1000 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no. No pool today? 30-40 min elliptical at a conversational effort is the fallback, not a replacement to prefer.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Catch-up	Both arms start extended. One arm pulls and recovers while the other waits out front; the recovering hand touches the waiting hand before the next stroke starts. Purpose: long stroke, front-quadrant timing, patience in the glide.
Stroke count	Count strokes per 25 m (one arm = one stroke). Write down your normal count, then try to hold pace with one fewer. Purpose: efficiency and distance per stroke.
Zipper	During recovery, drag the thumb up the side of the body from hip to armpit before reaching forward. Purpose: high elbow recovery and body rotation.

Shoulder and stroke log (0 = no pain, 10 = worst pain)

Session	Shoulder during	Next morning	Strokes per 25, fast	Best 25 or 50 time	Notes
Monday					
Thursday					